BUS311 Individual Company Capstone

CFO and Board Decision Brief | Fall 2026

Project: Individual analysis of one publicly traded U.S. company
Audience: The selected company's CFO and Board
Term: Fall 2026
Status: Approved student release | Canonical source version 1.3.0 | Updated: August 11, 2026

This assignment is an individual, semester-long corporate finance project. You will select one publicly traded U.S. company, investigate how the company generates revenue and value, propose one potential company-specific CFO decision during Stage 1, and defend an implementable recommendation to the company's CFO and Board.

At a glance

Requirement	Standard
Ownership	Individual work; one company per student
Company	One approved public company listed in the United States
Primary audience	The selected company's CFO and Board
Decision	Stage 1 proposes one potential CFO decision; later stages develop one evidence-backed company-specific decision with two or three supporting actions
Required analytical spine	Revenue engine, 3-5 years of sales performance, revenue drivers, testable revenue hypothesis, valuation and scenarios, and an implementable recommendation
Evidence	Stage 1 introductory research plus one concrete FactSet learning; later stages use traceable SEC, FactSet, Excel, and other credible named sources
AI	Stage 1 may use AI and/or ordinary web search; four bounded checkpoints and verification begin after Stage 1
Final communication files	An 8-10-slide PPTX Board presentation, with optional analytical appendix slides, plus a one-page executive summary PDF
Excel	Required and assessed at the valuation milestone; not a third final communication file
Presentation	7-minute Board briefing plus 3 minutes of individual Q&A
Project value	100 project points, equal to 25% of the BUS311 course grade
Final-file deadline	Monday, Nov. 30, 2026 at 12:30 p.m. ET, when class begins

Purpose

Corporate finance is not only about calculating a value. It is about deciding what a company should do, explaining why, and showing how the decision can be implemented and monitored. This capstone asks you to connect a company's operating reality to finance: how sales are generated, what drives future cash flows, what assumptions matter, how value changes across scenarios, and what action the CFO should recommend to the Board.

Your work should answer one central question:

> *Given the company's revenue engine, financial position, market expectations, and risks, what specific action should the CFO recommend to the Board, and what evidence would make that decision credible and implementable?*

Market valuation is supporting evidence. A Buy/Hold/Sell rating is not required and will not substitute for a CFO decision.

Learning outcomes

The capstone integrates BUS311 learning outcomes LO2-LO6. By completing it, you will demonstrate that you can:

Learning outcome	Capstone evidence
LO2: Explain the key financial statements and the information each provides.	Use the income statement, balance sheet, cash-flow statement, and filing notes to explain revenue, profitability, reinvestment, financing, and cash generation.
LO3: Conduct ratio analysis using balance sheets and income statements.	Calculate and interpret company trends and relevant peer ratios, then connect them to operating performance and the CFO decision.
LO4: Apply time value of money principles to present value, future value, and yield-to-maturity calculations.	Use discounted cash-flow or other instructor-approved valuation methods and explain the timing and discounting of cash flows.
LO5: Explain factors affecting the cost of money, interest rates, bond markets, and stock markets.	Evaluate discount rates, financing conditions, market expectations, capital structure, and scenario risk where relevant to the company.
LO6: Evaluate long-term capital-budgeting decisions.	Compare alternatives using incremental cash flows, value creation, risk, implementation constraints, and decision criteria appropriate to the developed CFO question.

Your role and required decision

Act as an internal corporate finance analyst advising the selected company's CFO and Board. Stage 1 begins with one potential decision; later stages turn that idea into an evidence-backed recommendation.

By the final stages, your decision must:

1. Ask one specific question that the CFO and Board could act on.
2. Address a material company issue with genuine alternatives.
3. Identify two or three supporting actions that make the primary decision implementable.
4. Require quantitative evidence and at least two BUS311 concepts.
5. Explain how the decision could affect revenue, cash flow, risk, financing, or value.
6. Identify an implementation path, responsible functions, timing, performance indicators, and decision triggers.

Stage 1 is exploratory. You do not need to verify the recommendation, validate a hypothesis, compare or defend alternatives, build an evidence register, prove the claim, or secure a formal approval gate. Those more rigorous activities begin in later stages.

Strong CFO decision suggestion menu

Choose one direction that seems connected to your company, then rewrite it as a potential company-specific decision. Treat it as a beginner starting point that may change.

Decision area	Strong decision question	Evidence the question should require
Capital allocation	How should the company allocate its next material dollar among organic investment, acquisitions, debt repayment, dividends, and share repurchases?	ROIC, free cash flow, leverage, investment pipeline, payout capacity, and valuation implications
Capital structure	Should the company increase, reduce, refinance, or restructure debt?	Debt schedule, maturities, coverage, credit risk, interest rates, WACC, and peer leverage
Corporate development	Should the company pursue an acquisition, joint venture, partnership, or strategic divestiture?	Strategic rationale, valuation, financing, synergies, integration risk, alternatives, and return thresholds
Growth investment	Which major product, market, geographic, capacity, or technology investment should receive funding?	Revenue drivers, incremental cash flows, NPV/IRR, strategic fit, scenarios, and execution risk
Market expectations	What operating or capital actions are required to meet or challenge the expectations embedded in the company's valuation?	Market-implied growth and margins, consensus estimates, scenarios, and operational feasibility

Decision area	Strong decision question	Evidence the question should require
Operating performance	What operating and capital actions are needed to improve ROIC, margins, or free cash flow?	Revenue bridge, cost drivers, capital base, peer comparison, implementation metrics, and valuation impact
Payout policy	Should the company change its dividend or share-repurchase policy?	Free-cash-flow durability, leverage, reinvestment opportunities, dilution, valuation, and shareholder expectations
Portfolio strategy	Should the company expand, repair, divest, or discontinue a business segment?	Segment revenue, margins, growth, capital intensity, strategic fit, and valuation contribution
Risk management	Which interest-rate, foreign-exchange, commodity, refinancing, or concentration risk requires a financial response?	Exposure size, sensitivities, mitigation cost, downside scenarios, and governance triggers
Working capital	How should the company improve cash conversion, inventory, receivables, payables, or liquidity?	Cash-conversion cycle, peer benchmarks, seasonal needs, cash impact, and customer or supplier consequences

In Stage 1, a potential decision only needs to be specific enough to guide future research. Later stages make it analytical and defensible. "Improve profitability," "grow the company," and "buy, hold, or sell the stock" are not acceptable primary decisions.

Required analytical work

1. Explain the revenue engine

Map how the company earns revenue. Address each item below or state, with evidence, why an item is not applicable:

- Products and services
- Reportable and economically meaningful segments
- Geographies and customer types
- Sales and distribution channels
- Pricing or monetization model
- Recurring versus transactional revenue

The map must show where value is created and which levers management can influence.

2. Analyze 3-5 years of sales performance

Use consistent fiscal periods, currency, units, and definitions. Show total revenue and material segment or business-line revenue for three to five fiscal years. Explain any restatements, acquisitions, divestitures, changes in segment reporting, or fiscal-year changes that affect comparability.

3. Decompose revenue drivers

Use the drivers the company actually discloses or that credible evidence can support. Depending on the company, these may include price, volume, mix, currency, acquisitions, customers, locations, utilization, retention, backlog, subscriptions, capacity, or another company-specific driver. Separate durable drivers from temporary, acquisition-related, accounting, or macro effects.

4. Add industry and peer context

Explain relevant demand conditions, competitive position, market share when supportable, peer growth, and macro or industry factors. Name the peer group, explain why it is appropriate, and use at least three peers when three comparable companies are available. If fewer than three are defensible, explain the limitation.

5. Identify leading indicators and principal revenue risks

Identify the company-specific indicators the CFO and Board should monitor. Address material concentrations, seasonality, capacity constraints, customer behavior, demand risks, and other forward indicators. Each indicator or risk must have a named source and a stated connection to a forecast assumption or decision trigger.

6. State a testable revenue hypothesis

Write one specific causal or directional claim that evidence could support, modify, or reject. The hypothesis must name:

- The operating driver or causal mechanism
- The expected revenue or margin effect
- The relevant time period
- The observable evidence that would support or disprove it

The hypothesis must flow into your base, upside, and downside assumptions and into the developing CFO decision.

7. Build valuation and scenarios

Translate the revenue diagnosis into base, upside, and downside forecasts. Use the instructor-approved valuation or capital-budgeting method appropriate to the company and decision. The Excel model must separate inputs, sources, calculations, outputs, checks, scenarios, and sensitivities. It must include the relevant tax, NOPAT, depreciation, capital expenditure, change in net working capital, discount-rate, terminal-value, and enterprise-to-equity logic when those items apply.

The model must contain no unexplained hardcoded result, unresolved formula error, or scenario that is disconnected from the revenue hypothesis. State material limitations rather than inventing unavailable data.

8. Make an implementable CFO recommendation

Recommend one primary action and two or three supporting actions. Compare the recommendation with credible alternatives. Specify:

- Why the recommended action follows from the revenue and valuation evidence
- Principal tradeoffs and risks
- Responsible executives, teams, or functions
- Timing and implementation sequence
- Performance indicators and decision triggers
- Risk mitigations and conditions that would cause the CFO to pause, change, or reject the plan

Milestones and Fall 2026 calendar

The dates below are mapped to the Fall 2026 BUS311 syllabus. Canvas will contain the final submission times and assigned presentation order. Unless Canvas states otherwise, written milestone files are due by 11:59 p.m. Eastern on the date listed.

Date	Syllabus connection	Required submission or activity	Points	Outcomes
Wed., Sept. 2	Week 1: FactSet sign-up and "Select Company & Why"	Select an approved public company; record its name, ticker, and exchange; then begin introductory AI and/or web research plus required FactSet exploration.	Included in Milestone 1	LO2-LO3 foundation
Wed., Sept. 9	Week 2: company research begins	**Stage 1 - Company research and potential CFO decision: submit the exploration brief with a company snapshot, one concrete FactSet learning and the screen/report/feature used, and one tentative CFO decision. No evidence register, verification, or approval gate is required yet.**	5	LO2-LO3 foundation
Mon./Wed., Sept. 28/30	Week 5: Project Check-In #1	Bring work in progress both days; submit **Milestone 2 - Revenue engine and initial hypothesis** by Wed., Sept. 30.	8	LO2-LO3
Wed., Oct. 21	Week 8: 10-K and FactSet company research	Guided evidence and model-development workday; update the evidence register. No separate project points.	0	LO2-LO5 support
Wed., Nov. 18	Week 12: WACC and long-term finance concepts	Submit **Milestone 3 - Excel valuation model and scenarios** after the scheduled WACC work.	8	LO4-LO6
Sun., Nov. 22	End of Week 12, before Thanksgiving recess	Submit **Milestone 4 - CFO red team and revision**, including the final accept/modify/reject record and revised decision logic.	4	LO2-LO3, LO5-LO6
Mon., Nov. 30 at 12:30 p.m. ET	At class start, before the first presentation begins	Submit the two final communication files: PPTX and one-page executive summary PDF. Files lock at the shared deadline.	Assessed below	LO2-LO6 integration
Mon., Nov. 30; Wed., Dec. 2; Mon., Dec. 7; Wed., Dec. 9	Weeks 14-15: Company Analysis Presentations	Deliver the 7-minute Board briefing and complete 3 minutes of individual Q&A on the assigned date.	20 delivery/Q&A points	LO2-LO6 integration

Milestone 1 - Company research and potential CFO decision (5 points)

Submit one Stage 1 company exploration brief containing:

1. Company legal name, ticker, primary U.S. exchange, and fiscal year-end.
2. A short beginner-friendly snapshot of what the company does, based on AI and/or ordinary web search.
3. A brief note identifying whether you used AI, ordinary web search, or both for the introductory research.
4. One concrete thing learned from FactSet and the screen, report, or feature used.
5. One potential company-specific CFO decision written in your own words.
6. A short explanation of why the potential decision seems worth investigating.
7. Two questions you want to research in Stage 2.
8. A confirmation that Stage 1 is exploratory and does not yet require proof, hypothesis validation, alternatives, an evidence register, formal citations, or a formal approval gate.

Milestone 2 - Revenue engine and initial hypothesis (8 points)

Submit the required milestone template or equivalent instructor-approved format containing:

1. The complete revenue-engine map.
2. Three to five years of total and material segment revenue with definitions, units, and sources.
3. Company-relevant driver decomposition and a clear explanation of what changed.
4. Industry demand, named peer group, peer growth, and market-share context when supportable.
5. Leading indicators, concentrations, seasonality, capacity constraints, and principal revenue risks.
6. One testable revenue hypothesis that names the driver, expected effect, period, and falsification evidence.
7. An explanation of how the hypothesis will affect forecasts, valuation scenarios, and the CFO decision.
8. An updated evidence register and the verified Checkpoint 2 skeptical-CFO challenge record.

Milestone 3 - Excel valuation model and scenarios (8 points)

Submit the working Excel model and the required model-audit note. The model must include:

1. Revenue-linked base, upside, and downside assumptions.
2. Clearly separated inputs, sources, calculations, outputs, checks, scenarios, and sensitivities.
3. An instructor-approved valuation or capital-budgeting method appropriate to the developing decision.

4. Sourced assumptions and correct finance logic, including all applicable taxes, NOPAT, depreciation, capital expenditure, net working capital, discount rate, terminal value, and enterprise-to-equity items.
5. Visible checks for formula errors, scenario consistency, sign conventions, valuation bridges, terminal-value reasonableness, and sensitivity links.
6. Decision-oriented outputs suitable for use in the Board deck and appendix.
7. A short model-audit note describing method, major assumptions, checks performed, limitations, and the Checkpoint 3 AI assumption-audit judgment.

The Excel model is graded here as a working analytical artifact. It is not submitted again as a third final communication file unless the instructor specifically requests it for Q&A verification.

Milestone 4 - CFO red team and revision (4 points)

Submit a concise revision record containing:

1. Original revenue hypothesis.
2. Strongest AI challenge or alternative explanation.
3. SEC, FactSet, Excel, or course evidence independently checked.
4. Finding, including uncertainty or limitations.
5. Accept, modify, or reject judgment with rationale.
6. Revised revenue hypothesis.
7. Revised CFO recommendation, two or three supporting actions, alternatives, implementation steps, performance indicators, triggers, and principal risks.
8. Checkpoint 4 Q&A rehearsal record and final AI-use disclosure.

Evidence and FactSet expectations

Beginning in Stage 2: required evidence register

Beginning in Stage 2, maintain one evidence register throughout the rest of the semester. Every material quantitative claim, assumption, chart, and recommendation must be traceable. For each item, record:

- Claim, metric, or assumption supported
- Source organization and document or FactSet item
- Filing, report, or data date
- Fiscal period and units
- Metric definition and any adjustments
- Exact filing item, page, table, FactSet screen/report name, or stable link

- Peer group and selection rationale when applicable
- How the evidence is used
- Limitation, comparability issue, or uncertainty

SEC evidence

Use the company's filings as primary evidence where available. Relevant sources may include Forms 10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, DEF 14A, registration statements, and filed exhibits. Cite the form type, filing date, fiscal period, and specific item, page, or table. A homepage link or a generic reference to "the annual report" is not sufficient.

FactSet evidence

You may use SEC and FactSet evidence in BUS311 course deliverables. For each FactSet table, chart, estimate, ratio, or peer comparison, label:

- FactSet as the source
- The report, screen, chart, or metric name
- Data-through or retrieval date
- Units, currency, and period
- Metric definition or adjustment when it is not obvious
- Peer group and the reason for the peer selection when applicable

FactSet data must remain within permitted course use. Do not post licensed exports or screenshots publicly or upload raw FactSet exports or screenshots to a public AI tool. Use a student-written, sanitized summary when a bounded AI checkpoint needs context.

Source integrity rules

- AI output is not a source.
- A chart image is not evidence unless the underlying data and source are identified.
- Do not use AI-generated chart images as financial evidence.
- Reconcile conflicting figures or explain why definitions differ.
- State a limitation when evidence is unavailable; do not invent a number.
- Keep source labels legible in the PPTX and executive summary.

Later-stage free-tier AI rules: four bounded checkpoints

AI may challenge your work, help generate questions, or rehearse skeptical questions. It may not select your final decision, write the analysis for you, supply unverified financial evidence, perform the model in your place, or replace your judgment.

Use the C-A-P-A-J process at every checkpoint:

1. **Context:** Give only the minimum student-written, sanitized context needed.
2. **Assumptions:** State the assumptions you want challenged.
3. **Prompt:** Ask a specific skeptical or diagnostic question.
4. **Assess: Beginning after Stage 1, verify useful output independently with SEC, FactSet, Excel, or course concepts.**
5. **Judge:** Accept, modify, or reject the output and explain your decision.

Checkpoint	Permitted purpose	Required student record
1. Research-direction review	After Stage 1, challenge the potential CFO direction and identify research questions for later verification.	Potential direction reviewed, strongest challenge, evidence checked after Stage 1, and the next research questions
2. Revenue-hypothesis challenge	Ask a skeptical CFO to identify weak assumptions, alternatives, missing variables, and falsification evidence.	Original hypothesis, strongest challenge, evidence checked, finding, accept/modify/reject judgment, and revised hypothesis
3. Assumption audit	Ask AI to inspect a student-written, sanitized assumption list for omissions, internal inconsistency, and scenario risk.	Assumptions provided, issues raised, calculations or sources checked, corrections made, rejected suggestions, and reason
4. Board Q&A rehearsal	Rehearse questions on revenue, valuation, implementation, and risk using a student-written summary.	Questions asked, weak answers identified, evidence rechecked, revisions made, and final disclosure

The four checkpoints begin after the exploratory Stage 1 brief, and each must work in a free AI version. You are never required to use premium browsing, file upload, spreadsheet analysis, connectors, image generation, or a paid model. Do not upload a workbook, raw FactSet export, FactSet screenshot, personal information, instructor-only material, or nonpublic company information. If you choose not to use a commercial AI tool or cannot access one, request the instructor-provided equivalent challenge prompts and complete the same assess-and-judge record.

Your final disclosure must name the tool, checkpoint purposes, output retained, verification performed, and any point at which your judgment overruled the AI. Undisclosed or unverified AI-generated claims, calculations, prose, or visuals do not meet the assignment requirements.

Individual-work expectations

All company-specific research, evidence selection, analysis, modeling, writing, slides, presentation, and Q&A responses must be your own. You may discuss course concepts and software techniques with classmates, tutors, or the instructor, but you may not share or reuse company-specific analysis, model logic, source notes, written text, charts, slides, or AI records.

You are responsible for every figure, formula, statement, and recommendation submitted under your name. During Q&A, you must be able to explain how a number was calculated, why a source was selected, what would change the conclusion, and where uncertainty remains.

Document permitted assistance and follow the Endicott College Academic Integrity Policy and BUS311 AI policy. Unauthorized collaboration, fabricated sources, copied analysis, or undisclosed AI substitution may be referred under the applicable academic-integrity process.

Final submission requirements

Submit exactly two final communication files by Monday, Nov. 30, 2026 at 12:30 p.m. ET, when class begins. This is the shared final-file deadline for every student, regardless of assigned presentation date.

File 1 - PPTX Board presentation (40 points)

- Microsoft PowerPoint .pptx format
- 8-10 core slides; title and source slides count if they are part of the core sequence
- Optional analytical appendix slides do not count toward the 8-10 core-slide limit
- Core sequence must show the decision requested, recommendation, revenue engine, historical sales and drivers, testable hypothesis and red-team result, forecasts and valuation scenarios, supporting actions, implementation, and risks
- Appendix should contain only analytical support needed to defend revenue, model, sensitivity, source, and alternative questions
- Quantitative visuals must be editable or traceable to the underlying Excel, SEC, or permitted FactSet evidence; AI-generated chart images are prohibited as financial evidence
- Include concise source notes and a final AI-use disclosure

File 2 - One-page executive summary PDF (15 points)

- One accessible PDF page at U.S. Letter size and normal print settings
- Addressed to the selected company's CFO and Board
- Must state the decision requested, revenue-engine and operating thesis, testable hypothesis and red-team change, valuation/scenario conclusion, recommended action, two or three supporting actions, implementation priorities, responsible functions, timing, performance indicators, triggers, risks, tradeoffs, mitigations, compact source notes, and AI-use disclosure
- Use readable type, headings, and meaningful labels; do not reduce text to an unreadable size to force content onto one page
- Retain the editable source file in case the instructor requests an accessibility or layout correction, but submit only the PDF unless Canvas states otherwise

File naming

Use the naming pattern below, replacing bracketed text without adding spaces:

- BUS311_[LastName]_[Ticker]_BoardBrief.pptx
- BUS311_[LastName]_[Ticker]_ExecutiveSummary.pdf

Before submitting, open both final files from the saved copies and confirm that fonts, charts, links, source notes, and page or slide limits display correctly.

Presentation and individual Q&A

You will present on the assigned date as if briefing the company's CFO and Board.

Seven-minute Board briefing

- Start with the decision requested and your recommendation.
- Use the core deck, not the appendix, to communicate the required argument.
- Explain the revenue evidence before relying on valuation conclusions.
- Prioritize the analysis that changes the decision; do not narrate every slide or model tab.
- Finish within seven minutes. The instructor may stop the briefing at the time limit so every student receives the same presentation opportunity.

Three-minute individual Q&A

- Answer questions about revenue drivers, the testable hypothesis, sources, model assumptions, calculations, sensitivities, alternatives, implementation, and risks.
- Use appendix slides when they help answer a question, but do not use the appendix to hide a missing core requirement.
- If you do not know an answer, state the limitation and explain what evidence or calculation you would use next.
- Your answers must demonstrate individual ownership of the model and recommendation.

Presentation sessions are scheduled for Nov. 30, Dec. 2, Dec. 7, and Dec. 9, 2026, with a target of five presenters per class. The instructor will publish the order. Students are expected to attend the required sessions and participate in the professional Q&A environment. Absences and make-up presentations follow the applicable college and course policy and require prompt instructor communication.

Accessibility and professional-quality checklist

Before each milestone and final submission, confirm that:

- Headings follow a logical hierarchy.
- Tables have header rows and are readable without zooming excessively.

- Charts have descriptive titles, labeled axes, units, periods, and source notes.
- Color is not the only way information is communicated.
- Text and chart elements have sufficient contrast.
- Images and non-text visuals have meaningful alt text in PPTX or the source document.
- PowerPoint reading order is logical, and every slide has a unique title.
- Links use descriptive text rather than raw URLs when space allows.
- FactSet, SEC, and model evidence is labeled with dates and definitions.
- The one-page summary remains readable at normal print size.
- The deck can be understood by a CFO or Board member who has not seen your model.
- Microsoft Office Accessibility Checker issues have been reviewed and corrected or explained.

100-point assessment overview

The project is scored out of 100 points. It contributes 25% of the BUS311 course grade; therefore, each project point equals 0.25 percentage points toward the final course grade.

Milestones, Excel model, and revision - 25 points

Criterion	Points	Evidence used for scoring
Company exploration and potential CFO decision	5	Approved company, introductory AI and/or web research, one concrete FactSet learning with the feature named, and one potential CFO decision
Revenue engine and initial hypothesis	8	Sales structure, 3-5-year history, driver decomposition, peers, leading indicators, risks, testable hypothesis, and verified AI challenge
Valuation model and scenarios	8	Revenue-linked forecasts, sourced assumptions, correct finance logic, visible checks, base/upside/downside scenarios, sensitivities, and decision outputs
CFO red team and revision	4	Accept/modify/reject record, revised hypothesis, recommendation logic, implementation, risks, Q&A rehearsal, and disclosure
Milestone subtotal	**25**	

One-page executive summary - 15 points

Criterion	Points	Evidence used for scoring
CFO-ready synthesis	15	Decision requested, revenue and valuation thesis, recommended action, supporting actions, implementation priorities, responsible functions, timing, indicators, triggers, principal risks, sources, and disclosure

PPTX Board presentation - 40 points

Criterion	Points	Evidence used for scoring
Revenue engine and operating diagnosis	15	Company-specific sales model, 3-5-year evidence, driver decomposition, hypothesis, leading indicators, risks, and decision relevance
Valuation and scenarios	10	Revenue-linked assumptions, model outputs, sensitivities, market expectations, scenario differences, and limitations
CFO recommendation and implementation	10	Prioritized action, alternatives, tradeoffs, two or three supporting actions, timing, responsible functions, performance indicators, triggers, and mitigations
Visual evidence and source integrity	5	Readable and accessible SEC/FactSet/model-linked visuals, dates, definitions, source labels, traceability, and no unsupported AI figures
PPTX subtotal	**40**	

Individual delivery and Q&A - 20 points

Criterion	Points	Evidence used for scoring
Executive delivery	5	Seven-minute timing, presence, clarity, accessibility, audience fit, and individual ownership
Revenue, valuation, and model mastery	15	Accurate defense of sales drivers, hypothesis, assumptions, calculations, sensitivities, sources, risks, alternatives, and uncertainty
Delivery/Q&A subtotal	**20**	

Total: 25 + 15 + 40 + 20 = 100 project points = 25% of the BUS311 course grade.

Late-work and revision rules

Late-work rule

Milestones remain eligible for submission under the BUS311 syllabus late-work policy. A late milestone delays instructor feedback and can make dependent project work harder; complete missing milestone work before relying on it in a later stage. Documented exceptions follow the applicable college and course process. The final PPTX and one-page executive summary have a fixed shared deadline of Monday, Nov. 30, 2026 at 12:30 p.m. ET; later presenters may not replace those files after observing earlier briefings. An instructor-authorized accessibility or file-repair correction may not change the underlying analysis or recommendation.

Revision rule

Milestones 1-3 may each be revised once within seven calendar days of written instructor feedback. The revision must include a concise change log identifying the feedback addressed, evidence added or corrected, and resulting analytical change. Revised criteria are rescored under the published rubric, and the revised score replaces the original score when higher. Final communication files may not be replaced after the shared Nov. 30 deadline except for an instructor-authorized accessibility or file-repair correction that does not alter the analysis or recommendation.

Final readiness check

Before the final deadline, verify all of the following:

1. The company and final CFO decision are clearly identified and supported.
2. The decision is addressed to the CFO and Board, not framed as Buy/Hold/Sell.
3. Revenue analysis includes 3-5 years, company-specific drivers, a testable hypothesis, and scenario linkage.
4. Every material figure and claim is traceable to SEC, FactSet, Excel, or another credible named source.
5. The Excel model passed the required checks and contains no unresolved formula errors.
6. Exactly four bounded AI checkpoints are documented, independently verified, and disclosed.
7. The recommendation includes two or three supporting actions, alternatives, implementation responsibilities, timing, indicators, triggers, risks, and mitigations.
8. The final submission contains exactly two communication files: one PPTX and one one-page executive summary PDF.
9. The core deck contains 8-10 slides; any appendix is analytical support only.
10. Both files passed the accessibility and saved-file checks.
11. The presentation is rehearsed to seven minutes, and you can defend the work during three minutes of individual Q&A.